SONIA MALIK

AI-First Product Development Lifecycle (PDLC) · Faster Speed to Market with Enhanced Customer Experience

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Work sample (BEACON, AI governance built into delivery): https://soniamalik78-sys.github.io/prototypes/beacon/?src=guardian-leaders

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

24+ years in engineering and transformation leadership, starting as a hands-on engineer and now a **leader of leaders** — Senior Directors as direct reports at S&P Global; VPs as direct reports at DoubleVerify — much of it in regulated firms (S&P Global, Prudential, Guardian Life). Customer-centric by training and practice (Rutgers Mini MBA, Customer Centricity): every piece of work starts from a customer journey and its KPI; **AI creator agents and AI judge agents** do the legwork with human validation and governance built in; then the loop closes with continuous improvement driven by customer feedback analysis (NPS, CSAT, complaints, and reviewer edits). An early adopter of machine learning in engineering (Audible, from 2022). At S&P Global as **Head of AI PDLC** and chair of the AI Governance Committee: led 350+ engineers through Senior Directors on a $70M+ budget across two business units.

IMPACT AT A GLANCE

Speed with control	**3 days → same day** regulated sign-off, with evidence-backed human approval in the delivery pipeline (S&P Global)
AI adoption at scale	AI developer platform designed to serve ~1,200 engineers; **350+ engineers** on governed AI workflows within 13 months (S&P Global)
Faster delivery	Features delivered per PI up **30%** over 3 PIs; regression **9 days → daily** (S&P Global)
Customer and revenue	**$100M** revenue impact (Prudential cross-sell / unified customer dashboard, multi-product customers 3% → 5%); **$50M+** revenue and 550K new users (Audible); **NPS up 5 points** (S&P Global)
Quality and cost	Sev2s, security vulnerabilities and launch risk each down **30%** (Audible); production defects down **20%** in 6 months (S&P Global); QA cost down **50%** (Prudential)
People	**17 promotions**, including 2 to Director (S&P Global); leader of leaders with Senior Director reports (S&P) and VP reports (DoubleVerify); 200+ contractors across five countries (DoubleVerify)

Core strengths: Customer Centricity (Rutgers Mini MBA) · AI-First PDLC Design · Journey-Led Delivery (customer journey → MVP → BDD stories → code) · Creator and Judge Agents with Human Validation · Closed-Loop Continuous Improvement from Customer Feedback · AI Governance Built into Platforms · Evaluation Gates & Observability · Quality Engineering & Non-Functional Testing · Operating Model & Org Design · Executive Scorecards · CISO / Risk / Compliance Partnership · Budgets $8M–$70M+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

S&P Global, New York, NY

August 2025 – September 2026

Vice President, Head of Quality Engineering · Chair, AI Governance Committee

Hired to revitalize Quality Engineering. Mandate expanded separately to Head of AI PDLC — re-architecting the product development lifecycle AI-first across two business units. Leader of leaders with Senior Directors as direct reports; $70M+ budget. Presented the multi-year strategy to executive leadership.

- **Creator + judge agents, closed loop:** AI creator agents drafted MVPs, features and BDD stories from customer journeys (goal, intent, KPI); AI judge agents scored outputs against rubrics before human validation; NPS, CSAT and journey KPIs fed continuous improvement back into the agents and the backlog — features per PI up 30% and NPS up 5 points.
- **AI-first PDLC end to end:** agent chain (code generation, testing, code-review and non-functional agents, deployment telemetry) with human review at defined risk points; every environment promotion gated by a release quality score; production defects down 20% in 6 months; regression 9 days → daily.
- **Governance as platform defaults:** as committee chair, with CISO, Risk, Compliance, Legal, Architecture and Controls, made privacy, security and regulatory requirements required pipeline steps; regulated sign-off 3 days → same day; AI developer platform designed to serve ~1,200 engineers; 350+ engineers on governed AI workflows within 13 months.
- **AI decision-support for Ratings** to launch readiness: flags market events and recommends a rating with rationale; the analyst decides before committee; customers moved to a new analytics platform in waves, with A/B results deciding each go/no-go.
- **Dev:QE ratio 2.5:1 → 4:1:** QE leaders embedded across delivery scrum teams and a 32-engineer central platform team; 8–10 tools consolidated into in-house platforms; 10+ third-party AI tools assessed against cybersecurity and controls criteria.
- **Leaders grown:** 17 promotions including 2 to Director; 4 leaders groomed for Senior Director; product owners of 10 scrum teams reported dotted-line; Girls Who Code mentor; AI framed as career-building upskilling across US, UK, Canada and India teams.

DoubleVerify, New York, NY

July 2024 – August 2025

VP of Product and Engineering – Head of Quality Engineering

Owned delivery governance and engineering productivity; leader of leaders with VPs and Directors as direct reports; $35M budget across the US, UK, Israel, France and Ireland. Lead mentor, #IamRemarkable: hosted sessions in London and NYC offices for 25+ participants.

- **Test cycles 20% shorter; manual effort down 25%** with AI-assisted test automation and predictive defect analysis behind guardrails and human review gates.
- **Global capability center across four countries:** third parties held to agreed delivery commitments and KPIs; 200+ contractors; SOX findings closed working directly with auditors.

Audible, an Amazon company, Newark, NJ
August 2019 – April 2024

QAE Director (CTO Office) – Consumer Domain QA Head

Led a technology-wide quality transformation; 10 SDEs reporting directly, 270+ indirect; $35M–$40M budget. Recruiter for Audible at Grace Hopper; Girls Who Code volunteer.

- **Sev2s, security vulnerabilities and launch risk each down 30%;** machine learning on production incidents from 2022 to find repeat-causing patterns; firm-wide Sev2 process revamp with Amazon's bar-raising teams.
- **Regression 5 days → 2** with smart regression that read code changes, defect-prone areas and business-critical features; common standards adopted by all 17 teams.
- **$50M+ revenue and 550K new users** supported through quality for global launches into newly added countries; non-functional testing center of excellence, including the accessibility framework; the customer experience her team created moved Audible's search ranking from 5th to 3rd.
- **4 → 41 engineers** plus 2 offshore centers; a senior lead promoted twice to Director and 4–5 engineers grown into managers.

Prudential Insurance Company of America, Newark, NJ
December 2015 – August 2019

Head of Quality Engineering (CIO Office) – Customer Office & Retirement Business Units

Girls Who Code mentor. Customer Office and Retirement on an $8M–$10M budget.

- **Multi-product customers 3% → 5%; $100M revenue impact** as QE lead for the cross-sell program on the unified customer dashboard.
- **UAT feedback from a week to 2–3 days** across 5 business units; testing time down 30% within 9 months through test environment and data virtualization; QA cost down 50%.
- **150+ engineers** (COBOL/mainframe) in regulated Retirement taken into the organization; 50+ reskilled into automation and 35+ roles moved with backup coverage; Customer Office QE group of 40+ engineers.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Pearson Technologies, QA Manager (2012–2015), revitalized the QE function · SanPulse Technologies, QA Manager (2011) · TheMarkets.com (merged with S&P Capital IQ), QA Lead (2006–2009) · Guardian Life, QA Lead Tester / Offshore Coordinator (2005–2006) · Sasken, QA Lead Tester (2003–2005) · HCL, Automated Tooling Support Engineer, writing code for customers' automation problems (2002–2003) · Siemens, Testing Intern and Consultant (2001–2002)

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & COMMUNITY

Master of Science (Computer Applications) and Bachelor's in Computer Science, Kurukshetra University · Rutgers Mini MBA (Customer Centricity), certificate · SAFe Scrum Master · CSM · CSPO · Speaker, QA Financial Forum (New York, 2019) · Recruiter for Audible at Grace Hopper · Girls Who Code mentor (Prudential, S&P Global); Girls Who Code volunteer (Audible) · Lead mentor, #IamRemarkable — London & NYC sessions, 25+ participants (DoubleVerify)

Hands-on: AI coding assistants and agents; evaluation gates, prompt-template libraries, agent monitoring, human-in-the-loop review. Familiar with: MCP, RAG, NIST AI RMF, ISO/IEC 42001, EU AI Act.